

KNOWLEDGE ARTICLE

OneDrive Files Not Syncing or Missing

Intent key	OneDriveSyncIssues	Category	File Storage and Collaboration
Routing	Bedrock Knowledge Base / LLM fallback	Lex overlap	No direct match in the supplied intent workbook

Purpose and intent scope

Use this article when OneDrive displays a sync error, files remain pending, expected files are missing, or changes are not appearing on another device.

Suggested answer

Open OneDrive on the web first and confirm whether the affected file exists online. Then review the first error shown by the OneDrive cloud icon, pause and resume syncing, close the file in other applications, and check the file name, path length, and available storage. Do not delete or unlink the local OneDrive folder before confirming that important files are safely stored online.

Common user utterances

- OneDrive is not syncing my files.
- My files are stuck on sync pending.
- A file is available online but not on my laptop.
- OneDrive shows a red X.
- My recent document changes are missing.
- The OneDrive folder stopped updating.
- I accidentally deleted a synced file.
- OneDrive says the file name is not allowed.

Recommended troubleshooting sequence

1. Confirm internet connectivity and open OneDrive on the web to check whether the file exists online.
2. Select the OneDrive cloud icon and review the first reported sync error.
3. Pause synchronization for a short period, then resume it.
4. Close applications that currently have the affected file open and retry synchronization.
5. Check that the file name does not contain unsupported characters and that the full folder path is not excessively long.
6. Verify that both the local disk and the OneDrive account have enough available storage.
7. Sign out and sign back in only after confirming that important files are visible online or backed up elsewhere.
8. For deleted files, check the OneDrive recycle bin before requesting restoration.

Security and safety boundaries

Do not recommend the following actions:

- Do not delete the local OneDrive folder to force a resync.
- Do not unlink the computer until important files have been confirmed online.
- Do not move confidential company files into a personal cloud-storage account.

When to escalate

- Files are missing both locally and online.
- OneDrive reports that the account is disabled, unlicensed, or blocked by policy.
- A large number of files have conflicted copies or repeated sync failures.
- The same library fails for multiple users.
- A deleted file is not available in the recycle bin.

Information to collect for support

- Exact OneDrive error message
- Affected file or folder path
- Whether the file exists in OneDrive web
- Approximate time of the last known correct version
- Available local and cloud storage
- Whether the issue affects one file or many files

Routing guidance for the assistant

Use this article when the request clearly matches the intent scope. Provide the suggested answer, then guide the user through the troubleshooting steps in order. Ask only for non-sensitive diagnostic details. If an escalation condition is met, recommend creating a support request and include the collected details. Never request passwords, MFA codes, private keys, or security tokens.

Knowledge-base note

This article was intentionally created for a topic not directly represented in the supplied Lex intent list. It is suitable for retrieval by an LLM fallback or Amazon Bedrock Knowledge Base. Internal service-desk URLs, approved software names, and organization-specific escalation paths should be added only after validation.